

Navigating challenges in CEL

Here is a long list of things that you might want to consider in advance of or during the process of setting up a community engaged learning programme.

Due diligence

Have you undertaken a due diligence process? Do you know what type of organisation you are working with? Do they have the required levels of insurance? Does the organisation have the correct policies and procedures?

Decision-making

How are decisions about the partnership made? Will you have a working group? A governance board? If it is just one CEL project, then a regular coffee and catch-up should do it.

Participation

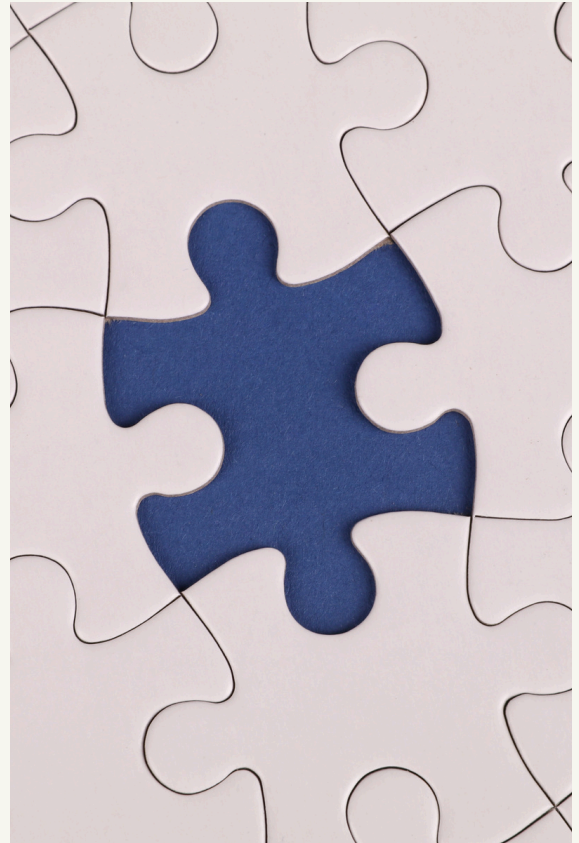
If you want to develop a collaborative relationship with the community, then any programmes should be co-governed between the university and the community.

Risk Assessments

Have you conducted a risk assessment? The level of detail required will depend on the activity. A desk-based activity will need a different risk assessment from an activity where students go out into the field.

Formal Agreements

Have you established a formal agreement between you and the partner? Is there one already in place? Who are the named leads for the University and the partner? Have you outlined the expectations of all stakeholders? Will outputs developed be available in the public domain? Who owns the outputs? What happens with any intellectual property that arises? Do you plan on publishing in a journal? Will confidential information be shared?



Management

What is the process for dealing with things when they go wrong? How will risks be identified, owned and managed?

Funding

How will this work be funded? Who manages the budget? Will partners be remunerated for their time? Will partners be remunerated for their time to ensure sustainability in the relationship?

Sustainability

How will the relationship be managed if any of the individuals involved leave their roles? (For example, is there a partnership between the organisations, people, or both?)



Activity: Read the Article

This article from [Elena Besussi](#) and [David Owen](#) reflects further on some of the challenges you might encounter particularly with assessments and the experiences of students and partners.

[MANAGING THE RISKS OF COMMUNITY-
ENGAGED LEARNING](#)

